



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

**RODEO** proponents leave the Los Angeles City Council chamber after the public comment period Tuesday.

## 2 sides arrive to save or buck rodeos

Proposed ban draws fans of the events and advocates for animals to L.A. City Hall.

By SUSANNE RUST AND MELISSA GOMEZ

Rodeos are causing a circus at City Hall.

On Tuesday, rodeo lovers and animal welfare advocates descended on downtown Los Angeles to argue for and against a draft ordinance that would ban the hooved spectacles within the city.

The thing is — the ordinance wasn't even on the agenda.

In 2023, the City Council voted unanimously to support the drafting of a ban by the city attorney.

But Councilmember Ysabel Jurado, the chair of the Arts, Parks, Libraries, and Community Enrichment Committee — which oversees rodeos — has yet to introduce the ordinance. The proposed rule, which was drafted in 2024, will expire at the end of the month if not brought to the City Council for a vote.

“Because this item was introduced before Councilmember Jurado took office, our office has taken a thorough and deliberate approach to reviewing the proposal and meeting with community stakeholders to fully understand its history, cultural context, and potential impacts,” said Alejandra Alarcon, a spokeswoman for Jurado. “We do not have a confirmed meeting date for this item at this time.”

The law defines rodeos as spectator events that include bareback and saddle bronc riding, bull riding, calf roping, steer wrestling, team roping, or any other event or activity that involves physically taking down an animal, roping an animal, or attempting to ride a bucking

[See Rodeo, A6]

## State awaits high court ruling on mail ballots

By KEVIN RECTOR

California's slow vote counting process — still underway and causing friction after last week's primary — may be forced to change before November's midterm elections, as the U.S. Supreme Court prepares to rule on whether mail ballots must be received by election day to count.

Whether those changes will speed things up — and help tamp down baseless claims from President Trump and others that the slow count is evidence of fraud — will depend on a variety of factors, election experts said, including how the high court rules, how state lawmakers and local elections officials respond, and whether they push any additional steps to quicken the count.

“We're all on the edge of our seats, waiting to see what the Supreme Court does,” said Kim Alexander, president of the California Voter Foundation.

“We're certainly planning for a bad Supreme Court decision in this case, but we don't really know all of our options for how to respond until we see the court's decision,” said Assemblymember Gail Pellerin (D-Santa Cruz), chair of the Assembly Elections Committee and a former top elections official in Santa Cruz County.

Pellerin said she has been working on contingency plans with other state officials — including some from the offices of Gov. Gavin Newsom, Secretary of State Shirley Weber and Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta — and has requested \$35 million in state funds to educate voters on any new midterm deadlines, though that funding has not been appropriated.

Federal law has, since 1872, set “election day” as the first Tuesday following a Monday in November. [See Ballots, A7]



JALAA MAREY AFP/Getty Images

**A MILITARY** patrol Tuesday in northern Israel, near the border with Lebanon.

### ANALYSIS

## Hurdle to a pact with Iran

Israeli war in Lebanon could hobble U.S. negotiations

By NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — For weeks now, President Trump has repeatedly promised — at least 37 times, by some estimates — an accord with Iran is around the corner. Yet an issue far removed from the conflict's epicenter may end up being the biggest obsta-

cle to any treaty: Lebanon.

That disruptive potential was well on display over 18 hours starting Sunday, when Israel attacked the Lebanese capital, Beirut, prompting Iran to lob missiles at Israel for what it said was its violation of the ceasefire. The Israeli strikes came after Hezbollah militants' rockets hit northern Israel.

The fracas escalated to exchanges of missiles and airstrikes that threatened to plunge the region into full-blown conflict once again, and even widen the war to include Yemen's Houthi rebels.

Calm was restored soon after President Trump somewhat frantically de-

[See Lebanon, A3]

**STRIKES ON IRAN:** U.S. attacks after crash of Apache helicopter. **NATION, A5**

## In L.A., the lampposts may have eyes

Security-driven push to add license plate readers to poles raises privacy concerns.

By LIBOR JANY

Since its creation more than a century ago, the Los Angeles Bureau of Street Lighting has been in the lamppost business and little else.

But in recent months, the little-known city agency has found itself pulled into a fierce debate over L.A.'s relationship with Flock Safety, a surveillance technology company that has been criticized for supplying data used to enable the Trump administration's immigration crackdown.

In L.A., Flock operates dozens of automated license plate readers, which allow authorities to scan for vehicles that have been reported

stolen or are registered to known fugitives, tracking their movements throughout the city.

The devices are often mounted on municipal light poles, which makes the Bureau of Street Lighting responsible for their installation.

Reports that Flock has shared license plate data with federal authorities, including U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, have prompted dozens of

mostly smaller cities across the country to end their relationship with the company. But in L.A. it still has found willing customers, including the LAPD.

Hundreds of emails obtained by The Times through public records requests reveal how LAPD boosters, homeowner associations and elected officials have engaged in a months-long campaign to pressure the Bureau of Street Light-

[See Surveillance, A10]

## Mayoral runoff is about to be a ‘knife fight’

With similar stances on policy, Bass and Raman are likely to go negative, experts say.

By DAVID ZAHNISER AND NOAH GOLDBERG

The gloves are off.

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass and City Councilmember Nithya Raman have only begun to wage their Nov. 3 runoff campaigns, but they're already trading sharp jabs about each other and their records.

“This November, voters will have a clear choice between myself and Nithya Raman, a difference that is made crystal clear because we have been changing L.A., while some people including the councilwoman ... fought to take L.A. backwards,” Bass said Tuesday in her campaign kickoff event at East End Studios in the city's Arts District.

Bass launched her salvo over the weekend, as the tally of mail-in votes made clear that Raman would edge out Spencer Pratt to challenge her in the fall election. Minutes after the results came out, the mayor issued a scorching statement blasting Raman for voting

against police hiring and the effort to keep homeless encampments away from schools.

Raman accused Bass during the primary of engaging in “pay to play” politics, saying special interests that benefited from the mayor's decisions — the police union, business groups and Airbnb — spent big on her reelection. Since then, she has described Bass as part of a status quo that voters rejected.

“For too long, City Hall has prioritized giving political advantage to powerful interests that fund elections,” Raman said in a statement Monday night, after the Associated Press determined that she would make the runoff. “Meanwhile, working people pay the price in higher rents, depleted services, and a city that has stopped working for them.”

Despite the attacks, Bass and Raman are aligned on a number of city policies. And because they agree on so many subjects, their best strategy in the runoff will be to tear the other down, said Rob Stutzman, a GOP political strategist in Sacramento.

“Neither of them can move credibly that far to the middle,” he said. “So can [See Mayor, A6]

## Hilton, Becerra to face off Nov. 3

The Trump-backed Republican secures the second spot in gubernatorial race.

By DAKOTA SMITH, NICOLE NIXON AND SEEMA MEHTA

Republican Steve Hilton, a former Fox News commentator, clinched one of the top spots in California's gubernatorial primary on Tuesday, earning him the right to challenge veteran Democratic politician Xavier Becerra in the November election to determine the state's next governor.

The contest offers voters two starkly different politicians. Hilton was endorsed by President Trump and has wooed his MAGA supporters, blaming Democratic policies for California's homelessness crisis, high cost of living and other entrenched ills. Becerra campaigned as a battle-tested warrior against the Republican president and a champion of affordable healthcare. He could make history as the state's first elected Latino governor.

“My mission is clear: to go to Sacramento, clean up the



RONALDO BOLAÑOS L.A. Times



GARY CORONADO For The Times

**AS OF** Tuesday evening, Xavier Becerra, top, had 27.9% of the vote and Steve Hilton 24.9%.

corruption, cut your costs, help your business, and fix our schools,” Hilton said in a statement Tuesday afternoon. “In the weeks ahead, we will lay out my plan in detail to make our state California — particularly for

[See Gubernatorial, A7]

### Clock ticks on Social Security

The fund's projected shortfall has moved up a year, to 2032, due to rising costs and spending. **NATION, A4**



STEFANI REYNOLDS Bloomberg  
**HOUSE** Speaker Mike Johnson on Tuesday.

### Border Patrol, ICE funds OK'd

The House approves nearly \$70 billion for immigration enforcement, sending the bill to the president. **NATION, A5**

**Markets** ..... **A10**  
**Opinion Voices** ..... **A12**

### City harassment of street vendors

Code enforcement officers in Riverside targeted mostly immigrants for years, report alleges. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

### Enjoying their World Cup ride

U.S. captain Tim Ream urges teammates to soak up the tournament on home soil days before it begins. **SPORTS, B10**

**Weather**  
Mostly sunny.  
L.A. Basin: 85/63. **B6**

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